

TL Corp CRM Portal v7.0

ULTIMATE Developer Handoff Spec

Design System + Branding Tokens + Screen Specs + Click-Flows + UI States + Microcopy + Quality Benchmarks

This is the final, no-excuses build document. The portal must be self-explanatory, premium, fast, and protective of TL Corp. It must behave like a modern SaaS app on web, iPad, and phone (SPA).

Prototype URL: crm-tl.vercel.app

0. NonNegotiables (If any of these fail, the system fails)

- Post-login behaves like an app (SPA): instant transitions, persistent nav, no full reloads.
- Role-based portals: Client / Employee / Admin share one database and one source of truth.
- 3Tap Rule for field actions: Navigate, Open Job, Clock In/Out, Add Photo, Add Task.
- Auto-save drafts everywhere + Resume Draft on return.
- Built-in help: guided tours + tooltips + microcopy + searchable help drawer.
- Audit trail on schedule, scope, approvals, publishing, deletions/archives.
- Client-safe publishing: Internal by default. Client sees curated, calm view only.

1. TL Corp Branding System (Implementation Required)

Goal: executive, premium construction-tech aesthetic. The UI must feel like a control panel, not a generic template.

- Logo is always top-left inside the app shell (desktop sidebar header + mobile header).
- Never stretch/distort logo. Maintain aspect ratio always.
- Clear space: keep minimum padding around logo equal to the height of the 'T' in the TL square mark.
- Favicon: TL square mark.
- App name displayed in header text as: 'TL Corp Portal' or 'TL Corp CRM' (choose one globally; do not mix).

1.1 Color Tokens (Exact Hex Codes)

Use tokens throughout the codebase. Never hardcode colors in components. Define for light mode now; dark mode tokens included for future.

- Primary / TL Blue: #0B2A4A (buttons, links, active states)
- Primary Hover: #0A2440
- Primary Pressed: #081D34
- Accent / Gold: #C7A252 (highlights, approvals, premium accents)
- Accent Hover: #B89245
- Background: #FFFFFF
- Surface (cards): #F7F9FC
- Border: #E3E8EF
- Text Primary: #0F172A
- Text Secondary: #475569
- Muted Text: #64748B

- Success: #16A34A
- Warning: #F59E0B
- Danger: #DC2626
- Info: #2563EB
- Focus Ring: #60A5FA (2px outline)
- Dark Mode (future tokens): Background #0B1220, Surface #0F1B2D, Border #22324A, Text #E2E8F0, Muted #94A3B8, Primary #3B82F6, Accent #D4B06A

1.2 Typography (Exact Recommendations)

- Preferred font: Inter (web). Fallback: system-ui, -apple-system, Segoe UI, Roboto.
- H1: 28–32px / 700 weight / 1.2 line-height (page title).
- H2: 20–22px / 700 / 1.25 (section titles).
- H3: 16–18px / 600 / 1.3 (subsections).
- Body: 14–15px / 400–500 / 1.5 (readability).
- Microcopy: 12–13px / 400 / 1.4 (helper text, hints).
- Numbers in dashboards: 24–32px / 700 (metric cards).

1.3 Spacing & Layout Scale (Exact)

- Use an 8pt grid with 4pt sub-steps: 4, 8, 12, 16, 24, 32, 40, 48, 64.
- Card padding: 16 (mobile) / 20 (tablet) / 24 (desktop).
- Button height: 44px minimum (touch). Primary buttons 44–48px.
- Input height: 44px; label above input; helper text below.
- Tap targets: minimum 44×44px everywhere.
- Max content width (admin): 1200px; center with side gutters.

1.4 Iconography + Illustrations

- Icon set: Lucide or Heroicons (choose one and commit). Stroke icons only; no filled cartoons.
- Use icons consistently: Jobs, Tasks, Photos, Docs, Time, Messages, Billing, Change Orders.
- Empty states use simple line illustration + one sentence + one primary button.

2. Component Library (Build these once; use everywhere)

This is what makes the app feel premium and consistent. Build a component library first, then screens.

- AppShell (desktop sidebar + mobile bottom nav)
- TopBar (search, notifications, help, user)
- Card (job card, update card, invoice card)
- Button (primary/secondary/ghost/danger)
- Badge (status pills)
- Toast (success/error/info)
- Modal (confirmations)
- Drawer (notifications, change summary)
- FormField (label + input + helper + error)
- SegmentedControl (tabs/filters)
- Skeleton loaders
- EmptyState component
- Avatar + user chip
- Table (admin only)
- FileUpload (drag drop)
- Stepper/Wizard (Create Project)

2.1 Button Styles (Exact)

- Primary: background TL Blue (#0B2A4A), text white, radius 12px, shadow subtle, height 44–48px.
- Secondary: white bg, TL Blue border 1px, TL Blue text.
- Ghost: transparent bg, TL Blue text; hover surface tint.
- Danger: red bg (#DC2626) only for destructive final confirm; otherwise outline.
- Disabled: 40% opacity + not clickable; show tooltip explaining why disabled.

2.2 Status Badges (Exact)

- Job status pills: Draft (gray), Scheduled (blue), Assigned (blue), Acknowledged (indigo), In Progress (blue), Pending Review (amber), Complete (green), Closed/Archived (gray).
- Task status pills: Open (gray), In Progress (blue), Blocked (amber), Ready for Review (indigo), Done (green).
- Always include text label + icon; never color-only.

2.3 UI State Matrix (Required for EVERY component)

Every interactive component must implement these states to feel 'best-in-class'.

- Default
- Hover (desktop)
- Pressed/Active
- Focus (keyboard): 2px focus ring (#60A5FA) + 2px offset
- Disabled
- Loading (button spinner / skeleton)
- Success / Error (when applicable)

3. Responsive Breakpoints + Layout Rules

- Mobile: 360–480px (single column, bottom nav).
- Tablet: 768–1024px (two-column where useful; bottom nav or compact sidebar).
- Desktop: 1024px+ (sidebar + content area; tables allowed).
- Never show dense tables on phones; convert to cards.
- Sticky critical info header in Job Bible on all devices.

3.1 Motion / Animation Spec (Exact)

- Drawer slide: 180–220ms ease-out.
- Modal fade+scale: 160–200ms ease-out.
- Toast slide in: 160–200ms.
- No bouncing; no playful easing. Motion must clarify state changes.

3.2 Performance Budget (Best-in-class feel)

- First meaningful paint after login: < 2.0s on 4G.
- Today screen data fetch: show skeleton immediately; render within 500–900ms typical.
- Optimize images: auto compress; lazy-load photo galleries; cache thumbnails.
- Offline-ready architecture (phase 2): queued writes; clear sync status UI.

4. Routing Map (Exact)

- Public: / (landing), /login, /register, /forgot-password
- Employee app: /app/today, /app/week, /app/jobs, /app/jobs/:jobId, /app/messages, /app/time, /app/more
- Client app: /client/overview, /client/updates, /client/photos, /client/billing, /client/change-orders, /client/messages
- Admin app: /admin/dashboard, /admin/jobs, /admin/jobs/:jobId, /admin/schedule, /admin/billing, /admin/change-orders, /admin/publish-queue, /admin/users, /admin/templates, /admin/reports

4.1 Built-In Help (No-Call System)

- First-run tour per role (one time; can replay from Help).
- Help drawer: searchable topics + 'How do I...' quick list.
- Inline microcopy header on each screen: 1 sentence describing purpose.
- Tooltips: '?' icons on any field that could confuse users.
- Error messages must include the fix (not generic).
- Every primary action must have a success toast confirming what happened.

5. Screen-by-Screen Requirements (Summary)

Implement the v5 screen specs exactly (Employee E1–E10, Client C1–C6, Admin A1–A8). Branding tokens apply on every screen: header logo, button styles, status pills, spacing scale.

- Employee Today: job cards + Navigate/Open/Clock In; change banner; quick add.
- Job Bible: sticky critical info + tabs; 'More' menu; back preserves scroll.
- Tasks: swipe actions; blocked reasons; completion photo gates.
- Photos: internal default + publish request; viewer actions; undo on delete.
- Daily Log: draft/submit; auto-save; task-from-issue prompt.
- Client: calm overview + action items; published photos only; pay invoice; approve CO with e-sign.
- Admin: create project wizard; dispatch; publish queue; CO and invoice flows; permission controls.

6. Security + Permissions (Best Practice)

- Role-based access control (RBAC) enforced server-side (not just UI).
- Project-level access: employees only see assigned projects; clients only see their projects.
- AuditLog table required: who/what/when/old/new for schedule, approvals, publishing, deletes/archives, status changes.

- Soft-delete/Archive policy: projects never hard-deleted; tasks/photos delete only within rules; docs versioned forever.
- Session security: secure cookies or token storage best practice; idle timeout optional; remember-device optional.
- Optional phase 2: Two-factor auth for admin accounts.

7. Deliverables Checklist (What Dev Team Must Hand Back)

- Design tokens file (colors, typography, spacing) used across codebase.
- Component library with storybook (optional but recommended).
- Role-based routes and guards.
- All click-flows implemented with confirmations, toasts, and undo rules.
- Help system: tours + tooltips + help drawer + microcopy headers.
- QA pass on iPhone + iPad + desktop; no broken flows.
- Exportable audit report view for admin (read-only).

8. Final Quality Bar (No higher level exists)

- Feels like a premium SaaS control panel the first time you open it.
- Anyone can use it without training calls.
- Every action is obvious and confirmed.
- Brand is consistent and executive-level across all portals.
- Documentation + audit trail are strong enough to protect TL Corp in disputes.